

# Education India



A Quarterly Refereed Journal  
of Dialogues on Education  
(ISSN 2278-2435)



A Quarterly Refereed Journal  
of Dialogues on Education  
(ISSN 2278-2435)

**Paper-7**

**Emotional Intelligence in Teacher  
Education Curriculum for Enhancing  
Professionalism**

Mr Vimal Singh  
Dr. Shraddha Padmaja Awasthi

# Emotional Intelligence in Teacher Education Curriculum for Enhancing Professionalism

Mr. Vimal Singh<sup>11</sup>

Dr. Shraddha Padmaja Awasthi<sup>12</sup>

## Abstract

*In this modern time teachers need to be very effective through their professional attitude. To develop the sense of professionalism among teachers their effective pre-service & in-service training is required. The curriculum for the teacher education program should be based on the needs of the society. Our aim should be on preparing better human beings rather than better professionals. The process should always focus on the type of product it requires. Therefore for making the effective teacher education curriculum, needs of children, the society & the institutions should be thoroughly studied.*

*In the light of various researches it can be said that emotional intelligence is positively correlated with professional attitude of the teachers. An emotionally balanced teacher can be a better professional & is also capable of solving learner's emotional problems in an appropriate manner.*

*In the advent of globalisation & technological advancement children are getting exposed to various types of information due to which teachers are losing their status of 'only source of knowledge'. Along with information, various social evils & pressures have entered into classrooms. Teachers are expected not only to impart updated knowledge & skills through innovative methods but also to help the students in coping with various types of emotional & social problems.*

---

<sup>11</sup> Junior Research Fellow, University of Lucknow.

<sup>12</sup> Assistant Professor, Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University, Lucknow

*In the present scenario teachers are supposed to be an indispensable person for the learners as well as for the society. For maintaining their vital status in the hearts of the students, teachers need to be professionals with a human touch & this can only be possible with the knowledge & practise of emotional intelligence.*

*Hence, there is a dire need of integrating emotional intelligence in the teacher education curriculum for developing professionalism in teachers.*

**Key Words-**Teacher Education Curriculum, Emotional Intelligence, Professionalism

### **Introduction-**

The confluence of globalisation & technological advancement needs individuals who can face the new challenges with intelligence, vigour & vitality. Individuals should not only be capable of moving ahead with high spirit but they should also be able to sustain their individuality. Whenever we talk about high rising building, we also like to discuss about its strong foundation. In case of bright children the foundation can only be laid by the good teachers. The teachers need to prepare their students for the challenges of individual & social development in the new global era. Since, children are human beings & not the machines so they do have their emotions & feelings as well. Hence while making them academically strong we must take care of their social & personal problems.

In this modern time teachers need to be very effective through their professional attitude. To develop the sense of professionalism among teachers their effective pre-service & in-service training is required. The curriculum for the teacher education program should be based on the needs of the society. Our aim should be on preparing better human beings rather than better professionals. The process should always focus on the type of product it requires. Therefore for

making the effective teacher education curriculum needs of children, the society & the institutions should be thoroughly studied.

### **Social Environment of the Children-**

The present global environment is moving with the waves of materialism & self-centeredness. In this technological world the strings of relationships are connected through materialistic wires not with the emotional bonding. This situation is not only reducing the physical contacts between persons but also reducing the sense of belongingness with each other. A sense of void is taking place among people even though they are surrounded by different gadgets. Social networking sites are taking place of social gatherings where people used to share their feelings & emotions with each other.

Children are finding solace in the company of cell phones, computers etc. & are placing them at the place where they themselves are not aware of their own identity. The quick functioning of these gadgets is making them restless & impatient. They are learning to respond at the spur of moment. They have no time to sit & think & then respond.

The environment in which today's children are living is not giving them much scope to think about themselves leaving alone thinking about others. In this highly competitiveness world they find themselves as one of the runners, whose only aim is to get success in the form of money, power & status. When they find themselves unable to achieve their aim they develop the problems like depression, frustration, suicidal tendency, anger, violent behaviour, aggression, self-destruction, phobia, anxiety, pessimism, obsession etc. These problems lead to other mental as well as physical issues. And if these issues are not catered in time then they make the situation more critical.

It is necessary to keep the children away from self-destructive tendencies as these emotional problems put a negative impact on the academic achievement of the students. To cope with these negative tendencies a person should be able to know how to understand ones' emotions & then to express them properly. This capability can be developed through the learning of emotional intelligence.

### **Emotional Intelligence-**

EI (Emotional Intelligence) involves the ability to accurately perceive, appraise and express emotions; the ability to access and/or generate feelings when they facilitate thought; the ability to understand emotion and emotional knowledge; and the ability to regulate emotions. These abilities underlie a number of contemporary workplace variables that are not typically accounted for by IQ and personality.

Daniel Goleman identified the five 'domains' of EQ as: knowing your emotions, managing your own emotions, motivating yourself, recognising and understanding other people's emotions and managing relationships, i.e., managing the emotions of others.

“Emotional intelligence is the ability of an individual to appropriately and successfully respond to a vast variety of emotional inputs being elicited from inner self and immediate environment. Emotional intelligence constitutes three psychological dimensions such as emotional competency, emotional maturity and emotional sensitivity, which motivate an individual to recognize truthfully, interpret honestly and handle tactfully the dynamics of human behaviour”. (Dalip Singh 2003)

Emotional intelligence can make a huge difference to well-being and stress. There have been many well-documented studies conducted on the effectiveness of

emotional intelligence which show that emotional intelligence has positive impact on behavior, attitude as well as on reducing stress.

### **Relationship between emotional intelligence & performance-**

There are various researches conducted on relationship between emotional intelligence & performance of the individuals. The researches show that emotional intelligence plays an important role in the performance of the individuals.

In a study conducted with the obstetrics department of a major urban hospital in Bologna, Italy, the healthcare professionals high in emotional intelligence scored far better in an assessment of job performance and life success. The highest performers scored an average of over 30% better on the “Six Seconds Emotional Intelligence Assessment”, a powerful measure of essential competencies for being smart with feelings.

There are various researches based on emotional intelligence & stress. According to Joseph Ciarrochi, Frank P. Deane and Stephen Anderson EI (Emotional Intelligence) makes a unique contribution to understanding the relationship between stress and three important mental health variables, depression, hopelessness, and suicidal ideation. University students (n=302) participated in a cross-sectional study that involved measuring life stress, objective and self-reported emotional intelligence, and mental health. Regression analyses revealed that stress was associated with: (1) greater reported depression, hopelessness, and suicidal ideation among people high in emotional perception (EP) compared to others; and (2) greater suicidal ideation among those low in managing others' emotions (MOE). Both EP and MOE were shown to be statistically different from other relevant measures, suggesting that EI is a distinctive construct as well as being important in understanding the link between stress and mental health.

Since suicides are directly related to mental health so they are also related to emotional intelligence. The authors of a research work studied whether the presence of emotional intelligence is protective against suicidal behaviors in youth with a history of childhood sexual abuse. The findings provide preliminary evidence that emotional intelligence is in fact a protective factor for suicidal ideation and attempts. In addition to the clear relevance of the research for suicide prevention, there are additional implications relevant to mental health and public health that are explored.

Hence it is clear from the above mentioned researches that emotional intelligence plays an important role in making the individuals stress free & better performers.

#### **Emotional Intelligence & Academic Performance-**

There are various factors which are responsible for the academic performance of the students. One of the most important factors is emotional stability. An emotionally stable student will be able to concentrate more on creative & constructive work.

The research conducted by Preeti Bhadouria on the topic '*Role of Emotional Intelligence for Academic Achievement for Students*' says that the correlation between emotional intelligence and academic achievement and teaching emotional and social skills at school not only positively influence academic achievement during the year when these were taught but also leaves the impact in long term achievement. Findings of this paper presents that academic achievement without emotional intelligence does not indicate future success and absence of emotional intelligence also indicate the weak personality and ability to build relations at working place as well in schools and it is highly important for quality education.

#### **Professionalism in Teachers -**

Professionalism is a consequence of the extent of commitment on the part of individuals constituting the same. Teaching profession assumes that every teacher needs to be committed to it. The most crucial teacher commitment areas are- commitment to the learner, commitment to the society, commitment to the profession, commitment to attaining excellence for professional actions & commitment to basic values.

Teachers are not only supposed to excel in their professional skills like making the teaching learning process more effective, enhancing their own qualification etc. but they are also supposed to help the learner in his/her progress & development and at the same time teacher should play a significant role in the upliftment of the society. Teachers should always be alert & aware of the new happenings around them and should always be ready to face new challenges.

Teachers' performance is evaluated majorly on the basis of their academic performance & their students' achievement. Most of the time teachers' attitude & behaviour towards students is not given due weightage. Teachers are the role models for their students. Students learn mannerism, behaviour pattern, communication, attitude, expression of emotions & feelings etc. only by observing their teachers. Hence, it becomes necessary for them to behave in a proper manner as they are always under the vigilance of the students.

### **Relationship between Professionalism in Teachers & Emotional Intelligence-**

There are a number of researches which show that teachers' effectiveness is positively correlated with emotional intelligence. It is also proved that an effective teacher plays a pivotal role in making better students.

A research was conducted on the topic '*The Relationship between Teachers' Emotional Intelligence and Sense of Humor, and Student Achievement*' by Susan Fernandez. The findings of this research demonstrated that there are significant and

positive relationships between all variables of the study. Through regression analysis and partial correlation, emotional intelligence, in comparison to sense of humor, was found to have a stronger relationship to students' positive score changes. This study has the possibility of changing hiring and evaluation practices of teachers, curriculums of teacher preparation programs in institutions of higher education, teacher professional development activities, and the relationships among school stakeholders. This study may also initiate changes in the value systems within schools so that the psychological needs of not only students, but also teachers and other school personnel gain importance.

Another study conducted by Clyde Winters on the topic '*Emotional Intelligence and Teaching*' tries to find out the answer for various questions. It says 'that Is mastery of content knowledge enough to make a teacher effective and stimulate learning and academic achievement of their students?' It is becoming increasingly clear that teacher self-efficacy and empathy play an important role in teacher efficiency and effectiveness (Crain, 2005; Goleman, 2005; GLEF, 2005). Although we know that empathy and teacher self-efficacy play major roles in the effectiveness of teachers ,and the learning of their students, we know very little about how a teacher's emotional intelligence contributes to the development of the empathy they must demonstrate in their teaching, classroom management and interactions with their students generally, and high teacher self-efficacy appraisals. The research of Goleman (1995,2005) suggest that teachers become more effective when they are aware of the influence of emotional intelligence on learning and behaviour.

Hence it is clear that emotional intelligence helps teachers in becoming better & effective professionals. An Investigation of the *Relation between Emotional Intelligence and Organizational Commitment (Cause Study of High*

*School Teachers in Bushehr Province*) was conducted by Tayebah Shahamiri, & Raheleh Namdari. The present study aims to identify the relationship between emotional intelligence and organizational commitment of high school teachers in Bushehr province this cross-sectional study using a questionnaire survey among secondary school teachers in the school year 2010-2011 were a Bushehr province. The results showed that emotionally intelligent teachers having more commitment towards their organizations.

A study on the topic '*Emotional Intelligence of secondary school teachers in relation to their professional development*' was conducted by Samir Kumar Lenka & Ravi Kant. According to the researchers there is a general agreement that learning is a lifelong process and an educator's best practice involves dedication to lifelong learning and a commitment to personal & professional growth. For this educator's must be equipped with sufficient knowledge, skill and awareness in order to carry out their jobs. One of the critical aspects involved in the development of a healthy, personally accountable, & successful person is Emotional Intelligence. In this study with a sample of 120 secondary school teachers results revealed that there is significant positive relationship between emotional intelligence and professional development of secondary school teachers. The analysis of the above researches shows that professionalism in teachers can only be made effective with the understanding of emotional intelligence. If we want to have better students then we should have better teachers equipped with the qualities of professionalism and professionalism is not complete without emotional intelligence.

#### **Integration of Emotional Intelligence in the Teacher Education Curriculum-**

Teacher Training Institutes prepare the trainees for becoming effective, enthusiastic, committed & competent professionals to teach secondary school

children. Secondary school education is an important aspect of the entire education system because it is addressed at the most crucial & demanding stage of life. The professionally trained and emotionally balanced individuals are required to teach at this level.

In this global era new technological advances have taken place. They are not only shaking the status of teachers but also putting various obstacles in the life of teachers. Teachers today are not only supposed to use new & innovative teaching strategies but they also have to make an important place in the hearts of the students.

Society is facing a lot of issues like, social disintegration, value crisis, violence, destructive & impatient youth, materialism, irresponsibility, frustration etc. In this period of trauma & distress it is expected from the teachers to come forward & become torch bearers for showing the right path to the future of the nation.

Emotionally unrest children need persons to express & address their emotional issues & this can only be done by emotionally intelligent persons. This is the right time to include emotional intelligence in the teacher education curriculum if we really want to have professionally developed individuals. It will not only help in making better teachers but will also help the teachers in regaining their status in the society which they used to have many years ago. If we fail to sail along with the waves we will sink. Therefore if we have to maintain the status of teachers as an indispensable part of the society, we must try to revamp our training process.

Teacher education curriculum may include or integrate emotional intelligence in the form of workshops, projects, presentations & various other activities.

## **Conclusion-**

An effective teacher education program should have an in-built capacity to respond to the changes & emerging needs of the society. Teacher education program should not only be formulated properly but should also be implemented with the same spirit. The program should be well executed with the help of dynamic management, well trained faculty & staff and the members of the society. The teacher education program should be evaluated on the basis of its objectives. The evaluation process should be continuous & comprehensive and on the basis of evaluation outcomes the program should be modified & reformulated. Teacher education program should be relevant, creditable, useful, acceptable & renewable. The major aim of any teacher education program is to produce academically & emotionally strong individuals. Instead of focusing on academic success to produce smart people, there needs to be a shift towards producing emotionally well balanced individuals.

There are certain identified competencies which need to be acquired for sustaining professionalism in teachers. Apart from acquiring academic proficiency & commitment towards profession, there are certain human qualities which need to be acquired by the teachers. The students, the parents & the society look up to the teachers for proper guidance to solve various personal & social issues.

The emotional well-being of children and adolescents is also the responsibility of the education system. As we all are aware that social-emotional problems are a barrier to learning, and put a negative impact on future success of the learner. Hence, Teacher education program needs to be re-evaluated & re-invented to justify its relevance in present scenario.

In the light of above mentioned researches it can be said that emotional intelligence is positively correlated with professional attitude of the teachers. An

emotionally balanced teacher can be a better professional & is also capable of solving learner's emotional problems in an appropriate manner.

In the advent of globalisation & technological advancement children are getting exposed to various types of information due to which teachers are losing their status of 'only source of knowledge'. Along with information, various social evils & pressures have entered into classrooms. Teachers are expected not only to impart updated knowledge & skills through innovative methods but also to help the students in coping with various types of emotional & social problems.

In the present scenario teachers are supposed to be an indispensable person for the learners as well as for the society. For maintaining their vital status in the hearts of the students, teachers need to be professionals with a human touch & this can only be possible with the knowledge & practise of emotional intelligence.

Hence, there is a dire need of integrating emotional intelligence in the teacher education curriculum for developing professionalism in teachers.

#### References-

- Ciarrochi, J. V., Deane, F. P. & Anderson, S. (2002, January 1). *Emotional intelligence moderates the relationship between stress and mental health*. Retrieved from [http://works.bepress.com/stephen\\_anderson/2/](http://works.bepress.com/stephen_anderson/2/)
- Goleman Daniel. (2005). *Emotional Intelligence*. New York: Bantam books.
- Mohanty Jagannath.(2007). *Teacher Education*. New Delhi: Deep & Deep publications pvt. Ltd.
- Preeti Bhadouria (2013). [Role of Emotional Intelligence for Academic Achievement for Students](#). Retrieved from [http://www.isca.in/EDU\\_SCI/v1i2.php](http://www.isca.in/EDU_SCI/v1i2.php)
- Singh Dalip.(2006).*Emotional intelligence at work*. New Delhi: Sage publication

- <http://6seconds.org/sei>
- [http://academia.edu/351060/Emotional Intelligence and Teaching 1](http://academia.edu/351060/Emotional_Intelligence_and_Teaching_1)
- <http://gradworks.umi.com/34/67/3467199.html>
- <http://www.ajmse.leena-luna.co.jp/ajmsevol1n1.php>
- [http://www.textroad.com/pdf/JBASR/J.%20Basic.%20Appl.%20Sci.%20R...s.,%203\(1\)1062-1069,%2020...](http://www.textroad.com/pdf/JBASR/J.%20Basic.%20Appl.%20Sci.%20R...s.,%203(1)1062-1069,%2020...)

\*\*\*\*\*